

The Little Book of Donna

Table of Contents

1. A note before you begin	3
2. Profile at a Glance	4
3. Who She Is	5
4. Before the Rift	6
5. The Day the World Broke	7
6. Her Grammar — What "Settling" Actually Means	8
6.1. Attunement, not command	8
6.2. An aura, not a button	8
6.3. Only Donna can stabilise	9
6.4. What the world becomes without her	9
7. Her Powers, Named	11
8. What She Wears	12
8.1. The Rodopska nosia	12
8.2. Motion encodes personality	12
9. Two Lands, One Heart	13
9.1. Why the Rift chose both of them	13
9.2. How she sees Anya	13
9.3. What they share, underneath the contrast	14
10. Her Side of Slavia	15
10.1. A possible path	15
10.2. Spirits of her heritage	15
10.3. Flora and healing	15
10.4. What she wears, as she grows	15
11. Quotes & Moments	16
12. Fan Corner	17
13. Open Questions for Further Development	18
13.1. About Donna herself	18
13.2. About her powers and path	18
13.3. About her world	18

Chronicles of Slavia

"What do you become when the world breaks?"

Chapter 1. A note before you begin

This is a fan-style compendium of everything currently known about **Donna**, one of the two player characters of *Chronicles of Slavia*. It is written from inside the world — the way a devoted player might compile a character guide — but every fact in it is drawn from the game's actual design canon ([docs/design/*.md](#)), the Zone A game data ([engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml](#)), the engine source, and the playable prototype ([prototype/zone-a/index.html](#)).

Where the canon is genuinely settled, this book states it as settled. Where the canon is still open — an unanswered question the designers themselves have flagged — this book says so plainly, and collects those questions at the end for whoever picks up the design next. Nothing here is invented lore dressed up as fact.

Chronicles of Slavia is presently a private, exploratory prototype (Level 1, Zone A only — "Border Path"). This book describes a five-percent-built world. Treat everything past Zone A as **design canon for later**, not shipped content — this is called out chapter by chapter.

Chapter 2. Profile at a Glance

Field	Donna
Nationality (in-world)	Bulgarian — Rhodope mountains
Defined by	Structure — physical, emotional, intellectual. "Order, but order with compassion."
Her gift (attunement)	Lowers taxis — calms, settles, steadies, reassures. She draws out an animal's peace.
Native terrain	Mountains — stronger aura, more damage resistance, heals over time
Weakening terrain	Swampland — diminished aura, more vulnerable
Motion verve	0.42 (planted, damped, measured — see Motion encodes personality)
Emotional flaw	Carries too much responsibility; refuses to ask for help
Hidden strength	Her calm is not passive — it is powerful; she can stabilize anything she touches
Costume	Rodopska nosia — sukman, riza, prestilka, woven belt, headscarf (see What She Wears)
Colours	Near-black, earthy Rhodope red and black, white
Signature abilities	Brace, Anchor Step, Heavy Lift, Reinforce, Logic Link
Bond	One of two halves of a single guardian spirit — Donna is its structure , Anya its impulse

Chapter 3. Who She Is

Donna is a Bulgarian girl defined by structure — physical, emotional, intellectual. She builds things, repairs things, organizes things. She is **order, but order with compassion**.

That last clause matters more than it looks. This is not a game about a "stern, orderly" character who exists to be a counterweight to a "wild, chaotic" one. Donna's order is explicitly, canonically **protective** — never rigid for its own sake. The design doctrine draws the line directly: her calm is not passivity, it is a kind of quiet power. She can stabilize anything she touches.

Underneath that competence sits a flaw the game is honest about: Donna **carries too much responsibility, and refuses to ask for help**. She is the one who fixes things, so she has learned — long before the Rift ever opened — to be the one who is fixed, always, for everyone else. What she has never quite learned is how to let someone hold **her** up.

Her order is not rigid — it is protective.

— docs/design/09-any-and-donna-backstories.md

Chapter 4. Before the Rift

Donna grew up in a mountain village near the **Rhodopes** — the range that runs along Bulgaria's southern border, famous in-world (and in life) for its weaving and its mask-carving traditions. Her family were makers:

- Her **grandmother carved kukeri masks** — the ritual masks worn in Bulgarian folk tradition to drive out evil spirits.
- Her **uncle built wooden bridges**.

From them, Donna inherited two things at once: craftsmanship, and a protective instinct. Long before any Rift, the village had already given her a role — "**the reliable one**." She was the girl who fixed things, who stayed calm, who didn't break, no matter what was asked of her.

But the design is careful to give this a cost. Inside, she felt trapped by the **expectation** of it. She wanted to explore, to create, to be something more than "the stable one" — a wish the story has not yet let her have, and one that quietly defines who she needs to become across the Chronicles still to come.

Chapter 5. The Day the World Broke

On the day of the Tear, Donna was doing exactly what the village expected of her: **repairing a collapsed walkway**. Mid-repair, she paused at a strange vibration running through the wood under her hands.

The mountains rumbled; the kukeri carvings glowed; the ground folded like paper. She didn't fall because she slipped — she fell because the Rift opened beneath her. It saw her order. It needed her order.

— docs/design/09-any-and-donna-backstories.md

The wording is deliberate and worth sitting with: Donna did not stumble into the story. The Rift did not take her by accident, the way a disaster might take anyone standing nearby. It **saw** what she already was, and it **needed** exactly that. Her order — her whole life's habit of holding things together — is not incidental to the plot. It is the reason the plot has her in it at all.

Chapter 6. Her Grammar — What "Settling" Actually Means

Donna's core gift is not a superpower bolted onto her from outside. In the design's own words, her abilities are **emotional extensions** of who she already was before the Tear — every one of them recognisable as "the girl who holds everything together," now made literal.

6.1. Attunement, not command

Animals in Slavia are never tools, pets, buttons, or controllable units — they are living participants, indicators, and sometimes helpers. Donna and Anya do not **command** animals. They **change the rhythm of the world around them**.

Donna tends to calm, slow, settle, quieten, or reassure natural animals. The animal's own nature determines the result.

— docs/design/03-living-taxis.md

Mechanically, what she moves is called **taxis** — the rate and direction of a living thing's motion and response (the biological sense of the word: an organism's taxis toward or away from a stimulus). **Donna lowers the taxis**. She calms, settles, steadies, reassures — she draws out an animal's **peace**, not its submission.

This is an important distinction the design insists on: Donna's gift works **with** an animal's own nature, drawing out its genuine, best self. It never imposes an alien state. A creature Donna has settled is still fully itself — just at peace. That is categorically different from an enemy who forces **Obedience** on a creature (mindless, will-less, an instrument). Donna's settling and an enemy's obedience can look similar from a distance; the game treats the difference as a moral line, not a cosmetic one.

There is a hard limit that holds no matter how skilled Donna becomes: **attunement amplifies a thing's nature, it never perverts it**. She can calm a creature; she cannot make it betray what it is.

6.2. An aura, not a button

The gift is described as an **aura** — it emanates from Donna and acts, passively, on what passes near her, magnified and honed with practice (the canon's own touchstone here is the Nen/Zen aura discipline from *Hunter × Hunter*: something you first leak unbidden, then

learn to sense, contain, and direct).

Mastery has two separate axes: **Strength** (how far and how powerfully the aura reaches) and **Control** (how reliably and selectively it acts). Early on, Donna's control is low and leaky — she can simply walk past a spot and nothing happens, where Anya walking past that same spot startles a bird into motion. That asymmetry is a deliberate feature of the early game, not a bug: it is what makes the two girls feel different to **play**, not just to read about.

6.3. Only Donna can stabilise

The taxis duality is not limited to animals — it extends to the world itself.

Only Donna can stabilise; only Anya can agitate. Neither can do the other's act.

— docs/design/06-attunement-and-modifiers.md

The stream bridge in Zone A is the game's first and clearest demonstration of this. Donna can still the crossing — settle its trembling, its instability — so that it can be walked. Anya, trying the same thing, can only set it **bucking and bullwhipping**: useless for crossing, though not useless for everything (an agitated bridge might later deter a pursuer — a possibility recorded, but not yet built, as the "Zone A climax idea: the marauder").

Donna stills the crossing. Now it can be crossed.

— prototype/zone-a/index.html

The line the game's own README uses to summarise the entire mechanic, in miniature, is built from exactly this scene:

Anya wants to cross. The bridge will not hold. Donna steadies it. Anya crosses because Donna has made the path hold. This is the game in miniature.

— README.adoc

6.4. What the world becomes without her

Together, Donna and Anya hold the world's taxis in balance — one lowering, one raising. Apart, the balance breaks, and the world tips wholesale toward whichever sister remains.

Anya taken (only Donna's lowering is left): the world grows over-sedate, lifeless — dulled and still — and stays that way, harder to rouse, until Donna reaches her.

— docs/design/06-attunement-and-modifiers.md

This is not flavour text. It is a standing gameplay pressure that persists until the two are reunited — the world itself makes Donna's absence, and Anya's, felt.

Chapter 7. Her Powers, Named

The design is explicit that none of these are magic bolted onto Donna from outside — every one is an **extension of stability** she already possessed before the Rift ever touched her.

Ability	What it is
Brace	She's always held things together.
Anchor Step	She creates stability wherever she stands.
Heavy Lift	She carries burdens, literal and emotional.
Reinforce	She strengthens weak structures.
Logic Link	She sees patterns others miss.

Chapter 8. What She Wears

Donna's costume is culturally grounded — not an aesthetic layered on top of her character, but the visual language of her whole nature. The design is explicit about getting the specific folk-costume region right: Donna is **Rhodope**, not Северняшка (Severnyashka, the two-apron costume of Northern Bulgaria) — a distinction the design canon corrects deliberately, because the Rhodopska nosia is "the sober, grounded one — the visual of stability," where Severnyashka would have sent the wrong signal entirely.

8.1. The Rodopska nosia

- **Sukman** — a dark, near-black, heavy, sleeveless pinafore dress over the chemise; ankle-length and grounded.
- **Riza** — the white chemise beneath, with embroidered sleeves showing.
- **Prestilka** (woven apron) — earthy Rhodope reds and blacks in geometric stripes; the Rhodopes are known in-world (as in life) for their woven wool textiles.
- **Woven belt** and **headscarf** — hair covered and neat; little movement.

8.2. Motion encodes personality

Both girls share a single procedural animation rig; a per-character **verve** value scales how energetically the body reacts to motion. Anya's is **1.0**. **Donna's is 0.42**.

Reactive element	Donna (low verve)
Body lean	slight
Walk bounce	planted
Jump height	low, heavy
Skirt	heavy, damped
Headscarf	barely moves
Hem sway	subdued
Reaction speed	measured

The design's own framing is worth keeping in mind: this is a schematic, game-scale **evocation** of the embroidery and costume detail, not a literal reproduction — a higher-fidelity portrait pass is explicitly a later art task. What is fixed now is the **behaviour**: Donna's whole body reads as grounded, before a single word of dialogue is spoken.

Chapter 9. Two Lands, One Heart

Slavia is not just geography. It is memory, medicine, folklore, and moral choice — a world where places remember what happened in them, where every act of courage, care, fear, resentment, trust, or betrayal leaves a mark on the land. Donna and Anya do not simply travel through it. They are read by it, healed by it, tested by it — and eventually, the design intends, they learn to heal it in return.

9.1. Why the Rift chose both of them

The design's deepest answer to "why these two girls" is metaphysical, not coincidental:

Slavia is a world built on balance, and Anya and Donna are two halves of one guardian spirit: Anya — the spirit's impulse. Donna — the spirit's structure. Together — the spirit's harmony.

— docs/design/01-world-principle.md

The Rift did not tear at them because they happened to be nearby. It tore at them **because** they are the one whole thing capable of being split. Their gift — attunement — belongs to them alone, in-world, for exactly this reason: it is not two gifted girls who happen to complement each other, it is one nature, split in two. The guardian spirit itself is glimpsed later in the design (Zone E of the planned five-zone map) and gathered piece by piece before that, through collectible Guardian Spirit Fragments — none of this is built yet.

9.2. How she sees Anya

Where Anya has always felt misunderstood, Donna is canonically the first person who doesn't try to slow her down. Donna's instinct instead is to **anchor** her — not restrain her, not correct her, **anchor** her, the way she anchors everything else she touches. The design notes that Anya trusts Donna more than she admits — a trust Donna, in turn, has never had modelled back at her: someone whose steadiness is **for** her, not extracted from her by circumstance.

The two can also **sense each other across the Rift itself** — not merely that the world tilts when one of them is missing, but a direct awareness that survives the barrier between them. This is the mechanical seed for future rescue missions, echo puzzles, and split-path levels: the world can separate their bodies, but never fully their bond.

9.3. What they share, underneath the contrast

Their differences — order/logic/stability against chaos/impulse/motion — are the engine of the game. But underneath the contrast, the design is careful to name what actually makes them the chosen pair:

- **Courage** — both push forward even when afraid.
- **Loyalty** — neither abandons the other; the emotional spine of the story.
- **Curiosity** — both want to understand Slavia, even by opposite routes.
- **Resilience** — they keep going even when the Rift reacts violently.

Chapter 10. Her Side of Slavia

Everything in this chapter is **design canon for later** — none of it is built in the current Zone A prototype, and several items are marked, in the source documents themselves, as still open to the owner's final word. It is included here because it is the clearest picture that exists of where Donna's story is **headed**.

10.1. A possible path

The design's parking-lot notes sketch three tentative class leanings for Donna — **Pillar, Architect, Guardian** — introduced, in-world, by an apothecary figure who "diagnoses a leaning and offers a path," asking the same question the whole game turns on: *"What do you become when the world breaks?"* No path has been chosen; this is a menu of possibilities, not a commitment.

10.2. Spirits of her heritage

The Bulgarian/Rhodope side of the world's spirit roster (candidate figures, not yet confirmed by the owner) includes the **samodiva / vila** (a forest-mountain nymph), the **stopan** (a house spirit — the home hearth), and unnamed gorski (forest) spirits. Like supernatural animals, a spirit's alignment is never shown as an obvious tell (no glow, no halo) — it is revealed only through behaviour, and the girls default to **innocent until proven guilty**, a naivety the design treats as part of their character, not a gap.

10.3. Flora and healing

If flora affinity follows the same taxis rule as animals — the design's stated intent, though unimplemented — Donna would still and root growth rather than quicken it: closing buds, deepening roots, calming a thrashing plant, retracting overgrowth. The purest restorative in Slavia, deliberately kept small and fixed rather than built into a sprawling recipe system, is the shared Bulgarian/Ukrainian staple: **yogurt and honey**.

10.4. What she wears, as she grows

The clothing system's second, still-conceptual layer — **pattern weaving** — would let Donna weave sacred-geometry motifs from the **Kanatitsa / Elbetitsa** line (Bulgarian folk-embroidery traditions) into her sukman as she develops. The design is emphatic that these patterns are never a "moveset of triggered special moves" — no cooldowns, no combos. They are passive, ambient, and above all **social**: a pattern is a blueprint of who you are, and the world reads it. *"You have THAT pattern? Then of course you are welcome here."*

Chapter 11. Quotes & Moments

Every line below is verbatim from the existing prototype, game data, or the game's own README — nothing paraphrased.

Donna: “Why didn’t I just stabilise the bridge, Anya?”

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Donna stills the crossing. Now it can be crossed.

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Anya crosses what Donna steadied.

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Two lands, one heart.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Shrine beat

For a moment, the world feels whole.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Overlook beat

The Rift awakens. The birds stop answering normally.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Fracture prelude

It saw her order. It needed her order.

— `docs/design/09-anya-and-donna-backstories.md`

Chapter 12. Fan Corner

Where her design comes from. The design's own touchstones document names *Hunter × Hunter*'s Nen/Zen aura system as the mechanical north star for Donna's (and Anya's) gift — a rigorous, rule-based system that reveals character rather than escalating into raw power, deliberately built **without** the shōnen "everything becomes an ultimate" trap. It also names *Axis Powers Hetalia* as the touchstone for treating Donna as a genuine **personification of a land** — Donna **is** Rhodope Bulgaria, the way that show's characters **are** their countries — while explicitly leaving Hetalia's comedy register behind in favour of something "mythic and earnest."

A line worth knowing. The design's one-sentence pitch for the whole game doubles as the tightest possible description of what Donna is **for**:

A folkloric Brothers-meets-Ōkami with a Trine-like switch between two girls — one who stirs, one who stills — and Nen-like systematic depth, set in a Slavic world that reads who you are.

— docs/design/18-touchstones-and-positioning.md

Legibility, in-world. A later design layer called *manpu* (manga-style visual shorthand — swirls, sweat-drops, sleep-marks) is proposed to make the world's hidden state readable at a glance. One sketched example belongs entirely to Donna: she settles a sheepdog until it visibly falls asleep (rendered with a manga "Zzz" mark), lowering its detection and opening a stealth route. Not built; a strong hint of what "settling" will eventually **feel** like to use.

Chapter 13. Open Questions for Further Development

These are drawn directly from what the design canon itself leaves unresolved — not invented gaps, but the actual open questions a next designer, writer, or wiki contributor would need to answer.

13.1. About Donna herself

1. What does Donna actually look like, beyond her costume and hair colour? No age, height, build, eye colour, or skin tone is specified anywhere in the canon.
2. What is Donna's surname, or her family's names? Her grandmother (the kukeri mask-carver) and uncle (the bridge-builder) are described only by role, never named.
3. What, specifically, was the "collapsed walkway" she was repairing on the day of the Tear — where was it, and why had it collapsed?
4. How does Donna actually **talk**? Only one line of dialogue exists for her in the whole corpus ("Why didn't I just stabilise the bridge, Anya?"). Is she formal, wry, terse, warm-but-guarded?
5. How did Donna and Anya first meet — before the Rift, or only after?

13.2. About her powers and path

1. Which of her three sketched class paths — Pillar, Architect, or Guardian — is she meant to lean toward, or is the choice left entirely to the player?
2. The imported (non-canon, flagged "to refine") material suggests Donna's anchoring, applied too rigidly, can **shear** things rather than protect them — is that tension something the finished story explores, or was it a discarded idea?
3. Does Donna ever learn to ask for help — the flaw the design explicitly names for her — and if so, in which Chronicle?

13.3. About her world

1. Which of the candidate Bulgarian/Rhodope spirits (samodiva, stopan, other gorski spirits) are confirmed canon, and do any of them appear in Chronicle I specifically, or only later?
2. Do plants have will of their own, the way supernatural animals do, or only the rare supernatural ones?

3. Is Chronicle I's tone meant to be calm and folkloric (as Zone A currently plays) or "surreal, dangerous, fast-paced" (as an earlier structure document describes it)? The design itself flags this as unresolved.
4. Is the eventual game switch-only between the two girls, or genuinely co-operative/simultaneous? Both are recorded in different documents as live possibilities.

This compendium reflects the design canon of Chronicles of Slavia as of the date it was compiled. It is not an official design document — treat it as a fan’s-eye map of what is known, built to make the next step easier to take.